

TECHNICAL WORK SUMMARY REPORT

SLT WhatsApp Business Integration — Agent Platform

Date: August 31, 2026

Subject: WhatsApp Agent Architecture Review & API Debugging Session

Prepared For: Team Lead / Project Stakeholders

Status: Action item pending — awaiting phone_number_id from Team Lead

1. Executive Summary

This report documents the technical work completed during today's session, covering two primary workstreams: (1) clarification of the SLT WhatsApp Agent platform's chat reassignment and history-persistence architecture, and (2) diagnosis and resolution of a Meta/SLT WhatsApp API configuration error that was blocking agent message replies. A configuration gap was identified as the root cause of the API error, and a request has been drafted for the Team Lead to supply the missing credential.

2. SLT WhatsApp Agent Architecture & Logic

2.1 Inactivity Reassignment Logic

The platform automatically reassigns unclosed chats belonging to agents who go offline (e.g., after 11:00 AM) to currently online agents. This is handled by scheduled background Cron jobs rather than real-time triggers.

- ReassignInactiveAgentChats — identifies chats owned by inactive/offline agents that remain open.
- RoundRobinAssignmentService — distributes the identified chats evenly across available online agents.
- Chats that have already been marked closed are excluded from reassignment and remain saved in history under the original agent.

2.2 Chat History Persistence

Conversation continuity is maintained regardless of reassignment. When a customer sends a follow-up message, or when a chat is reassigned to a new agent, the complete conversation history is preserved and made available to the new owner.

- History is linked to the customer's contact_id, not to the assigned agent.
- On reassignment or a new inbound message, the full thread is loaded into the receiving agent's UI, ensuring no context is lost.

3. Meta / SLT WhatsApp API Debugging

3.1 Issue Diagnosed

Agents encountered a red UI error — “A phone_number_id is required” — when attempting to send message replies through the platform.

3.2 Root Cause Identified

Investigation traced the failure to the outbound request payload sent to the /reply.php endpoint, which was submitting a NULL value for the phone_number_id field instead of the expected WhatsApp Business phone number ID.

3.3 Technical Fix Steps Completed

- Reviewed and updated the 'slt_whatsapp' configuration array in config/services.php.
- Identified that the SLT_PHONE_NUMBER_ID environment variable was missing from the .env file.
- Verified the gap via Laravel Tinker, confirming config('services.slt_whatsapp.phone_number_id') returned NULL / an empty string.
- Clarified the distinction between three related but separate identifiers used in the integration:
 - Customer phone number (mobile) — the end-user's WhatsApp contact number.
 - Message identifier (uuid) — a unique ID assigned to each individual message.
 - Business account phone_number_id — Meta's identifier for the sending WhatsApp Business number.

3.4 Action Item

A short request message has been drafted for the Team Lead to retrieve the exact WhatsApp phone_number_id required to complete the .env configuration. This is the final outstanding step needed to fully resolve the reply-sending error.

4. Outstanding Items

- Obtain the correct SLT_PHONE_NUMBER_ID value from the Team Lead.
- Add the value to the .env file and clear the config cache (php artisan config:clear).
- Re-test message replies end-to-end to confirm the error is resolved.

5. Notes

This summary was compiled from the discussion held during today's session and reflects the technical context available at that time. It does not draw on any external calendar or task-tracking system.